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**Saudi Drama: Commencements, Efforts, and Progression (10):
Gharam Walladah by Husein Siraj as an Epitome
المسرح السعودي: البدايات والجهود والتطور (10):
مسرحية "غرام ولادة" لحسين سراج نموذجاً**

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Abstract:

Drama enhances the audience's fondness and respects his or her general taste as one of its functions when exemplifying its objectives. It can be said that drama is a conveyance for systemizing social change and improving public understanding of societal concerns. Drama is a universal belief and a device for bringing about sociable enlightenment and civilization. Its presence contributes and donates to the growing public consciousness of societal necessities. As a component in a research series on Saudi theater and drama, this study seeks to give an indication of the beginnings, challenges, and evolution of Saudi drama and theater. The researcher has used critical analytical methodology in the investigation, shedding light on an example of Saudi drama dealing with the nature of history and poetry in drama. The research begins with a concise foreword and then moves on to address important literary issues, including the blossoming of Saudi drama and the history of Saudi drama in general. It then briefly discusses the characteristics of a Saudi play and its poet dramatist as an illustration of Saudi poetic drama. Husien Abdullah Siraj's verse play (غرام ولادة) 'Gharam Walladah (2)' is presented in this portion. The last section of this research is a brief discussion and conclusion.

Keywords: historical drama, passion, poetic drama, Saudi poetic drama

الملخص:

أحد الأدوار الهامة التي يلعبها المسرح هو أن المسرح يعمل على تعزيز ولع الجمهور واحترام ذوقه العام كأحد وظائفه عند عرض أهدافها، ويمكن القول أن المسرح هو وسيلة لتنظيم التغيير الاجتماعي وتحسين فهم الجمهور للضرورات المجتمعية، فالمسرح هو اعتقاد عالمي، وأداة لتحقيق التنوير والحضارة الاجتماعية، يساهم وجودها ويشارك في الوعي العام المتزايد بالضرورات المجتمعية، باعتبارها أحد مكونات سلسلة بحوث حول المسرح والدراما السعودية، تسعى هذه الدراسة إلى إعطاء إشارة حول بدايات وتحديات وتطور الدراما والمسرح السعودي، استخدم الباحث المنهج التحليلي النقدي في تحقيق هدف الدراسة، حيث سلط الضوء على نموذج من المسرح السعودي الذي تناولت طبيعة التاريخ والشعر في المسرح، يبدأ البحث بمقدمة موجزة ثم ينتقل إلى تناول قضايا أدبية مهمة، منها ازدهار الدراما السعودية وتاريخ الدراما السعودية عمومًا، ثم يناقش بإيجاز خصائص المسرحية السعودية وشاعرها المسرحي كمثال للدراما الشعرية السعودية، يُعرض في هذا الجزء المسرحية الشعرية "غرام ولادة (2)" لحسين عبد الله سراج، والجزء الأخير من هذا البحث عبارة عن مناقشة مختصرة وخاتمة.

الكلمات المفتاحية: العاطفة، المسرح التاريخي، المسرح الشعري، المسرح الشعري السعودي

1. INTRODUCTION

Drama is a universal phenomenon that is creative. The environment created for these occurrences is called drama. It is believed that the literature of drama and theater comes from religious festivals, singing melodies, ceremonial festivities, as well as historical spectacles, but it does not stop at that. It now deals with almost all categories of life. Drama can be used as an approach to affect social change and can increase public awareness of social issues and matters. Collective arts, like theater and drama, are valuable because they best represent social collaboration since they foster a sense of community and uphold the notion of others' needs.

Drama is certainly about telling a story, having a conversation, and putting on a show to create engaging and immersive experiences. Writing, directing, and performing in a play requires the confluence of many artistic disciplines, such as music, visual arts, and literature. Drama is a distinct and dynamic art form because of its multifaceted nature. The playwright, who creates the story, characters, and language that serve as a play's framework, is the architect of theater. Playwrights bring stories that connect with audiences to life through their imaginative vision. Writing a play is an extremely creative process that requires a profound understanding of human behavior, conflict, and resolution. Drama is always changing as a result of creativity and experimentation. Modern theater frequently combines classic storytelling approaches with cutting-edge technology. Experimental theater challenges audiences to engage with the performance in original ways, pushing the boundaries of what drama can be. This ongoing evolution ensures that drama remains a vibrant and relevant art form.

As stated by Al-Bayraq, et al, (2023), Drama is one of the oldest arts that has touched human concerns, memories, and dreams. This art derives its importance and effectiveness from the fact that it is a communicative art that conveys its message

through play and acting. It has always been a potent medium for social criticism and reform. Playwrights frequently utilize their works to question injustices, examine societal issues, and spark debate. For instance, Sami Al-Jama'an's *Death of the Author* employs symbolism as an allegory to make a strong point about the struggles Saudi theater suffers. In *Death of the Author*, the dramatist "depicts the experience of gaining inspiration from well-known Arab theatrical endeavors, such as those of renowned Arab playwrights, including Marun An-Naqqash, Saadallah Wannous, Ahmed As-Sebaei, Ahmad Abu Khalil Al-Qabani, Saqr Al-Rashoud, and several others" (Dahami, 2023c). Such works can inspire audiences to reflect on societal norms and advocate for change. Drama and theater have been integral parts of human culture and society for centuries, serving as powerful forms of expression, storytelling, and entertainment.

Drama has developed over time, from Greek tragedies of antiquity to modern plays that capture the complexity of the human condition. "In theatre, for instance, power has been a leitmotif in a plethora of dramatic works starting from Greek theatre up to the present-day stage" (Besbes, 2018). Theater and drama reflect cultural ideals, social conventions, and historical settings, acting as societal mirrors. Through performances, audiences learn about many historical periods and cultural contexts, as well as the subtleties of human behavior and societal shifts. For example, Husien Abdullah Siraj's social plays provide insight into the evolving social and administrative landscape of Saudi Arabia and the Arab world as a whole, in addition to being entertaining.

Theater engages both the emotions and intellect of its audience. By presenting relatable characters and situations, drama evokes empathy, allowing viewers to connect deeply with the narrative and characters. The emotional journey experienced during a play can lead to profound personal reflections and a better understanding of one's own emotions and motivations. Drama and theater play a

significant role in edifying and enhancing both group and personal development. Theater fosters creativity and encourages audiences to explore different perspectives and cultures. As long as there are stories to tell and audiences to engage, drama and theater will continue to thrive as vital expressions of human creativity. Moreover, watching and/or attending theater provides insight into language and history and increases human perspectives.

2. Objectives of the Study

One of the objectives of this research study series is to examine and demonstrate the uniqueness and originality of the initial stages and growth of one of the major literary genres. Drama and theater in the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia highlight special attention on the poetic drama Gharam Walladah in the second part of the study and its poet dramatist Husien Abdullah Siraj.

3. Research Methods

In the second part, the paper employs the critical-analytical approach as a means of measuring the study's events. The study is structured into four sections, in which the first provides an overview of some critical attitudes, opinions, and considerations toward poetic drama; the second is a critical and analytical examination of Saudi drama, including endeavors that aspire to success. The third and fourth sections are about the poet-dramatist Husien Siraj, who composed the verse play 'Gharam Walladah' as a successful poetic drama. Then a final report on the remaining issues covered by the discussion and conclusion.

4. RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

4.1. Poetic Drama

Poetic drama refers to plays written partially or entirely in verse. It combines the emotional power of poetry with the dramatic structure and performance aspects of theater. It has evolved through various cultures and time periods. Poetic drama has been important in many literary traditions. Notable examples include ancient Greek tragedies, Shakespeare's plays, and works by modern playwrights like T.S. Eliot, W B. Yeats, and many others. Dahami, (2016a; 2016b),

opines, "poetic drama avails itself through verse as its medium. It aims at expressing a condition of existence in a given period of time and space. The human mind with its moods and passions can express itself in verse more commendably than in prose". Furthermore, "In his theories of poetic drama, Eliot confirmed that entertainment is an important feature for a successful play". It has often been used to explore weighty philosophical, moral, or spiritual themes.

The use of poetic language in drama serves several purposes. It elevates the dialogue, lending a sense of heightened reality or otherworldliness to the proceedings. Poetic techniques like meter, rhyme, and figurative language can enhance the emotional impact of scenes and help convey complex themes or inner thoughts of characters in a condensed, powerful way. Poetic drama, also known as verse drama, is a form of theatrical performance where the dialogue and monologues are written predominantly in verse. This style of drama combines the structural and rhythmic elements of poetry with the narrative and performative aspects of theater; knowing that "poetry has a long history in the literary heritage and essays and short stories have counterparts in the ancient epistles and rhythmic writing" (Dahami, 2024). Furthermore, poetry is the preparation for art, inasmuch as it avails itself of the forms of nature to recall, express, and modify the thoughts and feelings of the mind (Kwasny, 2004, p. 35; Sutton, & Foster, 1963, p.37). By integrating poetry into the dialogue, poetic drama elevates the emotional and aesthetic experience, allowing for a more nuanced and layered expression of themes, characters, and emotions.

Poetic drama is a unique and expressive form of storytelling that combines the lyrical language of poetry with the performative elements of drama. It is a genre that seeks to elevate the human experience through the use of rich, evocative language, imaginative storytelling, and emotive performance. Poetic drama often explores themes that are deeply personal and universally relatable,

such as love, identity, and social issues. "This illustration can serve as a description of how [these three issues] are melting into one pot" (Al-Bawab, & Jarbou, 2023).

Critics of poetic drama have emphasized that poetic drama deals with the essence and spirit of life. It is capable of expressing the voice of the soul, of stirring the heart, and liberating the soul as it stimulates the imagination of the audience, whereas prose drama does not create this kind of impact on the viewers (Dahami, 2017a).

By fusing poetry and drama, this genre creates a powerful and immersive experience that can evoke strong emotions, spark critical thinking, and foster empathy and understanding. The importance of poetic drama lies in its ability to tap into the human experience in a way that is both intimate and universal. By using language, that is both beautiful and accessible, poetic drama can convey complex emotions and ideas in a way that is significant and impactful. This genre also provides a platform for marginalized voices to be heard, allowing for diverse perspectives and experiences to be shared and celebrated. Moreover, poetic drama could function as an effective instrument for social criticism, questioning the way things are and criticizing cultural standards using metaphor and allegory. It can inspire audiences to think critically about the world around them and to take action towards creating positive change.

The fusion of poetry and drama requires writers to think creatively and push the boundaries of traditional forms. This can lead to the development of new and innovative styles, forms, and skills that can enrich the poet dramatist landscape as a whole. Verse in drama "is the language of poetry and when, from time to time, the rhythm and the decoration of verse are applied, we have the sensation that a bird as opened its wings or a smooth-gliding ship set sail" (Dahami, 2017b; George, 1932, p. 177). Moreover, poetic drama can serve as a powerful tool for community cohesion, bringing people together through a shared experience that can foster empathy, understanding, and a sense of connection.

In an increasingly fragmented and divided world, the importance of poetic drama cannot be overstated. It has the power to inspire, to educate, and to bring people together in a way that is both beautiful and profound. In contemporary times, poetic drama remains relevant, offering a unique medium through which playwrights can explore complex themes and emotions. It challenges both actors and audiences to engage with the text on a deeper level, fostering a connection that goes beyond the superficial. See more at (Hegel, 2020, p. 221; Harding, 2011, p. 141). The enduring appeal of poetic drama lies in its capacity to capture the essence of human experience in a way that is both timeless and transformative, making it an essential and cherished form of artistic expression.

4.2. Saudi Drama: Endeavors Aspire to Success

Although the statement is not convincing to me, there are those who point out that the theatrical movement in the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia began many stages later than the Arab countries that preceded it in this field. However, in the early stages of the modern Renaissance, it surpassed many countries in various fields. To know the details of the emergence of Saudi theater, it is necessary to refer to some sources; although they are few, they may give a clear picture of this issue. Abdul Rahman Al-Khuraiji, one of the pioneers of the theatrical movement in the Kingdom, says in his book *The Origin of Saudi Theater*, which was published in 1986: There is no doubt that anyone who follows the literary paths in the greater Arab world will find that the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia was at the bottom of most Arab countries in terms of theater in its three types, the educational, the private, and the public. He might be surprised.

Saudi drama is considered an existing reality due to individual efforts and theatrical activity practiced on the stages of some cultural and educational institutions in the Kingdom, in addition to several external participants. Although theater as an organized social activity was absent locally

due to social-cultural conditions that narrowed its boundaries, this did not prevent the existence of theatrical texts written by Saudis that needed historical monitoring and dramatic analysis (Muthaffar, 2014; Aliwi, 2011; Muthaffar, 2009). There are those who add that the political, economic, or social climate did not begin until very recently, compared to the lives of other countries.

Everyone knows the condition of the Arabian Peninsula before the unification movement at the hands of the late King Abdulaziz Al Saud. This was an unstable situation in which it was impossible for the theater to exist in its comprehensive sense. This is due to the lack of a suitable climate for the emergence of theater among unstable Arabs. They are to sleep in the desert, covered by the blue sky, which is closer than finding literary galleries and showrooms. Despite the existence of this fact, more than one questioner wonders: What is the secret behind the backwardness of the Saudi theatrical movement compared to other areas of public life? To this, there are multiple answers. Someone might say that it is a loss of the theater's responsibility; another attributes the matter to the incompleteness of the theatrical structure; and a third explains it as the lack of literary fertile soil.

Many historians and those interested in Saudi theater point to the writer Ahmed Al-Sibai, one of the most prominent pioneers of literature in the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia, as the first to create literature for theater in the country. He was the first to establish a school to teach acting, the first to establish a special building for theatrical performances, and the first to introduce a director for theatrical works. The situation remained active for him, and he founded the "Dar Quraysh (House) for Islamic Performance." Studies also indicate that the writer and poet Hussein Abdullah Siraj was the first to create a Saudi poetic play, as he was mature in theatrical writing thanks to his living with Arab writers who had experience in this field. He is the author of the poetic play "The Unjust to Himself" (الظالم نفسه) in 1932, the play "Jameel and Buthainah" in 1943, and the play "Gharam

Waladah" in 1952. Then he also published "Longing for You" in 1974.

Here we stand thinking of the playwright Husien Siraj and his play 'The Unjust to Himself,' as we find that he wrote it in 1932, that is, in the same year as the establishment of the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia. From this, we realize and believe that Saudi theater emerged and began with the beginning of the Kingdom, despite knowing the various and many difficulties and challenges that accompanied it, due to the intellectual, doctrinal, and cultural factors at that time. However, the origins of Saudi theater go back to the year the play "The Unjust to Himself" was produced. Even if others disagree with me on this proposition, this is clear proof and sufficient evidence, I believe.

Esam Khogair is considered one of the pioneers of Saudi prose plays, and he is the most famous among them. He wrote a play entitled "The Vortex" "الدوامة" in 1380 AH. Then the audience became aware of his second play, "Happiness is a Promise," which was later turned into a television series. Nasser Al-Khatib says in his book *An Introduction to the Study of Theater in the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia* that Esam Khogair mentioned that when these plays were written, theater was not a readable art. The books read were collections, stories, and some novels. That is why I wanted to make theater a literary art like all other literary genres in Saudi literature.

After those incomplete beginnings of Saudi theater, the Ministry of Education had a prominent role in creating theater along with other educational curricula, as Mecca was the true beginning and departure. Ibrahim Al-Hajji chronicled this in an article in *Al-Jazeera* newspaper in 1405 AH; "Theatre began in Mecca at a more ancient beginning than the time of literary endeavors. Riyadh High School had a theater in which students practiced performances, and they also recited their poetic speeches and poems. Next to Riyadh High School, there were scientific institutes, the Sharia College affiliated with Mufti Sheikh Muhammad ibn

Ibrahim, and Al-Anjal Institute, which is now called the Capital Institute. In their early stages, these scientific houses used to practice different types of lectures, seminars, poems, and skits, and we call these attempts theater. "No one denies the great efforts and tries of Saudi theatrical attempts, which are tangible to every and each person either officially supported or individually organized" (Dahami, 2022). Nevertheless, their simplicity left an impact on people's souls and spread awareness that was linked to the culture close to society. See more at (Abu Zaid, 2003). These signs encouraged the Ministry of Education to establish theatrical activity as a branch of the general administration of school activity.

Experts were brought in, and the theatrical process began to take place in most of the Ministry of Education's educational facilities. Just as the Ministry had a role in the emergence of Saudi drama and theater, the Ministry of Information also had a role in spreading the name of the theater and giving a new concept to those who do not know what theater is. This was done through radio or television. In 1981, the Saudi Arabian Radio audience from Jeddah listened to the radio theater program, which was directed at the time by directors Mohsen Sheikh and Adel Jalal. This theater had multiple parts, including scenes and plays. These scenes and plays gave the Kingdom talented actors who had a place in the souls for a period of time; there were many. They are increasing day by day.

Lyrical poetry is sentimental poetry, but lyricism fused into drama and merged historically in several stages until it anchored in theatrical acting poetry, which critics called poetic drama. This type of literature opened other horizons for the development of the Arabic dramatic poem, which was driven by aesthetic needs. "Saudi Drama honors a number of pioneers who worked hard to create an environment conducive to the rise of drama at the national level" (Dahami, 2023a). With the change of times, the lyrical poem turned into something compatible with the developments of the modern situation, so

it was the dramatic poem or the theatrical poem, and one of its pioneers in the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia is Husien Abdullah Siraj.

4.3. Husien Siraj: a Poet Dramatist

Husien Siraj, poet, dramatist, and writer, is a Saudi literary innovator. He is one of the few persons who has united his love of literature with its genres like theater and poetry. In Saudi Arabia, Siraj "is one of the pioneers who mastered Arabic poetic plays among several others" (Dahami, 2023b). Siraj is one of the skilled experienced proficient Saudi literary figures who contributed to the growth of Saudi drama in the twentieth century. His literary ingenuity appeared early in his life and continued until he died in 2007. According to Banjar (2020), who stated that in 1912, in Taif, the literary figure and Saudi playwright Husien Abdullah Siraj was born. He grew up in a house of science and a family of educated people. He continued his education while traveling between Taif, Mecca, Jordan, and Lebanon. He lived a long life which majority of it spent in writing poetry, drama, a long series of dramatic sorties for the television theater, and social critical essays.

Husien Abdullah Siraj is an example of a comprehensive writer who understands the sublimity of emotion. If he treats emotion and tenderness in his poetry, he carries them in his poems addressed to the female; she is the mother, and the female is the wife. He holds the deepest human feelings in his poems directed towards the homeland, the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia. Husien Siraj is a literary giant who elevated his spirit and literature above the pitfalls of fame, so he lived ascetically in it, loyal to his art and literature.

Many critics and authors believe Siraj was able to apply his talent to historical material and create a poetic play, which helped to shape the phrasing of Arabic dramatic poetry. The poet dramatist was also able to broaden it to communicate the theatrical matter as well as consciousness, singing, and poetry around the same time. Husien Siraj entered the realm of serious Saudi rivalry for supremacy of Arab poetic play during its creation and growth. Husien

Siraj charted a challenging path for himself when he tried writing dramatic poetry. "Dramatic Poetry, on the other hand, unites the distinctive features of lyric and epic" (Appel, 1886, p. 247). It seems as though Siraj aspired to fulfill the legacy of great poets who came before him, as he was one of the pioneers of this poetic experience within the Arab poetry scene before Saudi Arabia's unification.

Therefore, he is considered an authentic pioneer in this type of poetry. Abdul Magsoud Khoja's Al-Ithnaineyah did well when they recently published his poetic and theatrical works in several sumptuous volumes. The role of Al-Ithnaineyah Forum was great in documenting this Saudi Arab heritage as a sublime literary heritage. Al-Ithnaineyah's publications included his previous printed literary works and new poetic and theatrical texts that had not seen the light before. Husien Siraj preferred silence and isolation without ceasing to write poetry and literature.

Critic Husien Bafakih, editor-in-chief of Al-Illam magazine, said that Husien Siraj is considered a big name in our culture and literature through his distinguished experiences in theatrical poetry, which he was devoted to and became associated with in our local literature. Husien Siraj was able, from an early period, to attract the attention of major critics and writers in contemporary Arab culture, including what the storyteller Mahmoud Taymour wrote about him in the introduction to his first poetic play, Gharam Walladah.

Husien Siraj is considered the founder of theatrical poetry in the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia. He published a poetic play entitled Gharam Walladah in 1952 AD in Cairo, and it was reprinted by Tihama Company in 1982 AD. It was presented by Mahmoud Taymour, who described it as having no superficial emotion. It contains deep responses to life, and it contains an introspection of the human tendency toward love. This emotion derives its strength from a high purpose and a distant goal. The ambition for glory and the demand for revenge work to direct that emotion and

lead it to lofty goals. See more at (Makkawi, 2015; Al-Fawzan, 2007; Bawazir, 2007; Suleiman, 2007).

Husien Siraj is referred to in literary circles as the founder of theatrical poetry and the dean of theater since the new era of the Arabian Peninsula. He presented his first written theatrical text in 1932. His literary and theatrical works continued later, including the play 'Jameel Buthainah,' which he released in 1943, and the play 'The Unjust to Himself.' However, the most famous thing he produced was a poetic play entitled 'Love of Birth,' which was published in 1952 AD in Cairo. It was reprinted in 1982 by Tihama Company, and the play 'Longing for You' was also produced. In addition, he produced dozens of plays for the Radio Theater, where he worked for a long time. Among his productions, were a series entitled 'Tears and Candles' and a radio program entitled 'Inspired by Al-Qur'an' (Al-Eqtisadiyah, 2009; Umm Al-Qura University, 1999, p. 371).

During his time at university, Husien Siraj read and learned a lot of writing about theater and drama, which sparked his interest in the performing arts. He attended several plays, too. He began writing plays and stories when he was young. He wrote his first play, "The Unjust to Himself," in 1932, followed by the play "Jameel and Buthainah, or Virgin Love," in 1943. After that, he turned his writings into poetic dramas and wrote his successful poetic play "Gharam Walladah," which was released in 1952 by the House of Knowledges (دار المعارف) in Cairo. See more at (Arar, 2017; Siraj, 2010; Digital Arabic Encyclopedia, n. d.).

4.4. Gharam Walladah 2: Success Attempt

The poetic play "Gharam Walladah" is a masterwork by poet-dramatist Husien Siraj, which various commentators see as an achievement. He could wander through a medieval Islamic literary arena while reading about the life of the innovative Andalusian poet Ahmed ibn Zaidoon. The drama revolves around his famed love for Walladah bent Al Mustakfi b-Allah. Husien Siraj, on the other hand, moves the spotlight to the poetess Walladah, despite stating that the

play criticizes the lyric's influence over dramatic components and features. According to philosopher and critic Mahmoud Taymour, this play, 'Gharam Walladah', is a rhythmic interpretation of the masterfulness of the poet dramatist Siraj that has passion as its main theme. Taymour called it a poetic drama inspired by history. This poetic drama tells the story of the princess, whose Eastern features and Arab characteristics paint a picture of love for us. The literary minds of prose and poetry examined the subject matter of this play. As for the play, I agree with him that it is more poignant and fortunate to have a beautiful melody.

The poetic play 'Gharam Walladah' is a poetic theatrical story with a coherent structure in its various verses. The scenario and dialogue overcame the narrative tendency and allowed the situation to be in harmony with the sometimes undulating emotional sentiment. In the play 'Gharam Walladah', the poet was able to achieve a combination of subjectivity and objectivity, as he had the basic elements of theater such as dialogue, conflict, and action. The structure of the play is integrated into 3 acts and 14 scenes, which were arranged in a harmonious, poetic, and representative format. The play is full of romantic situations, and some of its evidence is an image of the poet following the example of the prominent Andalusian poet Ibn Zaidoon.

Scene (Siraj, 2005); Siraj, n. d.) **المشهد الرابع**
four

ليلى: (تقف الحاشية) (تقف الحاشية)
ليلى: (تقف الحاشية) (تقف الحاشية)

Layla: Allow me to talk (the entourage stands apart)

ولادة: أي كلام

Walladah: What talk?

ليلى: عن سليمان وعن دسائس كثر

Layla: About Solaima and many intrigues

ولادة: وهل من جديد (هات يا ليل واصدقي)

Walladah: anything new (Come, O Layla, and befriend me)?

ليلى (متأثرة): أجل أنت في شكٍ لعمري من أمري

Layla (affected): By my life, you are in doubt about my situation

ولادة: لعلّي لم أجزحك بالقول فاسمحي

Walladah: Perhaps I did not offend you with what I said, so forgive

ليلى: فديتك مؤلاتي بمالي وبالغمر

Layla: I sacrifice my life for you, my lady, with my finances and life

ليلى (مستمرة)

(Layla continues)

بشاعر عصرنا افتتنت (سليمي)

وأمتت فيه والهة غراما

Solaima was fascinated by the poet of our time and fell in love with him.

تفديه بأنفس ما لديها

She ransoms him with all precious she has

ولادة: وشاعرنا يبادلها الهياما

Walladah: and our poet exchanges passion with her

ليلى: يميناً إن شاعرنا برىء لئن أنصفت قلت لقد تعامى

Layla: I swear that our poet is guiltless. If you were fair, you would say he was blind

ولما أخفقت عادت ليدس لعل الدس يبلغها

المزما

When she (Solaima) failed, she went back to poking, hoping that the poking would achieve her goal.

ولادة: فحاكت ما رويت قبيل ثوباً ويرداً من صنوف العار غاماً

Walladah: So she imitated what she narrated before, with a garment and a cloak of disgrace sorts like fog

ليلى: وهل ضرّ السحاب نباح كلب أو المزن الهطول بك الأيامي

Does the barking of a dog harm the clouds, or does the crying of maidservants harm the rain?

ولادة (للحاشية): اتركوني وليلى

Walladah (to the courtiers): Leave me alone with Layla

رباح: سمعاً وطاعة

Rabah: listening and obeying

ولادة: تجذنتك موطن الأسرار ليلى لأنني منك واثقة تماماً

Walladah: I took you to be the home of secrets Layla, because I am completely confident in you

لقد آمنت أن هناك دساً وطعنأ - سامح الله

الملاأ -

I believed there was intrigue and stabbing - may Allah forgive the blamed -

ولكن هل علمتِ هوىً جديداً حمى عن عين
شاعرنا المناما؟

Nevertheless, have you learned of a new
passion that has escaped the eyes of our poet
in a dream?

لذي النون الأمير فتاةً حُسنٍ بهذا الحسن
شاعرك استهما

Thu-Noon has become a beautiful mistress
for the prince; with this beauty, your poet is
in love.

وأصبح شادياً في كلِّ نادٍ وأمسى في الهوى
يشكو السقاما

He became a singer in every club, and at
night in love, he complains of monotony

ليلي: أتعنين ابنَ زيدون؟

Layla: Do you mean Ibn Zaidoon?

ولادة: ولم لا؟

Walladah: Why not?

ليلي: فديتك إنَّه كذبٌ ترأى

Layla: May I ransom you, it is a complete lie

يشيعه ابن عبدوسٍ ليطفي غليلاً شفه أبداً
ضراما

Ibn Abdus inflames it to extinguish envy
that love has burned his heart with fire

ويسحق بعدَ ذا قلبين عاشا خديني عفةً خلقة
نواما

And then to crush two hearts that lived in
exchange of love, and they were virtuously
created as twins.

These lines of the play show the
skillfulness of the dramatist in creating long
poetic dialogues in the perfect classical
Arabic language. The lines were well woven
by the mind of the poet dramatist before he
penned them. Of course, the translation will
not be identical to the original mother tongue
because, in translating poetry, the translator
might sacrifice the deep meaning at the
expense of poetic devices or the opposite. It
is very rare to find verse lines that can be
translated while keeping both their profound
meaning and their music.

It can be said that the entire
perspective of the play is one of gentle, lonely
speeches, like monologues. The play shows
affection that drives emotions and stirs up an
abundance of nostalgia and pride. The drama
possessing these qualities—the intensity of
emotion, the range of romance, and the
liveliness of the poetic style—is entitled to

appear on a platform among performers
recognized for their acting prowess as operas
or among vocalists recognized as operas,
where the aroma of a singing theater must
enhance the dramatic setting. Therefore, the
verse drama finds subtlety in the music,
which is accessible.

5. Suggestions for Future Research

The researcher's challenge in this
endeavor is that there is a dearth of
information, especially in English, about the
playwright, literary works, and the play that
is being studied. This is what I discovered—
that no one has ever studied Gharam
Walladah before. Further research is
recommended to learn more about the
literary-historical poetic play as one of the
literary legacies in the field of Saudi
literature, as well as playwright Husien
Abdullah Siraj as a prominent character in
Saudi writing, especially in the English
language.

Comparing "Gharam Walladah" with
other Saudi and Arabic plays will help
academics and literary authorities find
parallels and distinctions in themes, styles,
and social commentary. Further research is
advised in this area. They could provide
further insight into the origins, endeavors,
and development of Saudi theater and drama.
The play's lasting impact on Saudi theater
may be studied by future scholars, who will
look into how it influenced later plays and
themes in the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia. It is
also advised that more research be done to
examine how the historical, literary, and
poetic environment of Saudi Arabia
throughout the 1940s and 1960s affected the
topics and reception of the play.

6. Discussion

When evaluating the study's limits, it is
critical to remember that Saudi drama and
theater span a broad literary spectrum, and
this endeavor is unable to adequately address
all pertinent historical and contemporary
subgenres. These restrictions could make it
difficult to simplify the findings and
necessitate careful interpretation, particularly
in this concise research paper. Subsequent
study endeavors ought to aim to tackle these

constraints by doing numerous studies and inquiries that may potentially surmount the limitations, if any. The study's conclusions make a significant contribution to our understanding of Saudi drama and theater's relevance as a literary genre that is essential to society's welfare and knowledge.

This significant literary issue has been brought to light by the researcher's critical evaluation of the poetic play Gharam Walladah by Husien Siraj, comparison of the results to prior discoveries, and identification of untapped prospects for further research. Such markers provide a foundation for further research and development in this area, taking into account the constraints and limitations. This assignment, in general, highlights the importance of ongoing research on Saudi drama. It is anticipated that the results could guide and stimulate more study in this field.

Before interpreting the findings, it is crucial to offer a critical assessment of the body of research on this issue in the scientific literature. A literary description and analysis of the pertinent literature indicate that earlier research has been looked into. The same topic is covered in multiple articles. Even though the investigations have yielded insightful information, there are still several unanswered inquiries regarding this literary issue that demand more research. This study addresses a viewpoint that has not been examined previously. A play that exemplifies Saudi theater and drama is Gharam Walladah, which is taken as a reference in the study. This investigation uncovered several untried facets of the research subject that have not been explored in previous research, such as the drama Gharam Walladah, which has never been examined or evaluated by academics or literary critics.

7. CONCLUSION

Husien Abdullah Siraj was a skilled Arabic writer who could create a lengthy and intricate literary chain that linked several Arab pioneers, including Ibn Zaidoon, from the far West of the Arab world to the far East of the Arab world while also symbolizing himself. Because they share a similar nature,

the choice of the title Gharam Walladah also reflects the importance of the strong bond between Arab writers from the East and the West. The creation and development of Saudi theater, as well as its entrenchment in the Saudi literary scene, have been greatly influenced by a multitude of circumstances and notable individuals. In Saudi literature, Husien Siraj established poetic drama and brought it to the pinnacle of excellence with his poetic play "Gharam Walladah."

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